

IL CHUBBY BABI

Bruno Belotti

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IL CHUBBY BABI

BRUNO'S RECIPE BOOK

I STARTERS

II MAINS & COMPONENTS

BURGER BUNS

Makes anywhere between 4 very large buns and 8 small ones.

INGREDIENTS

Bread

- 450 g AP flour
- 235 ml water
- 1 egg
- 3 tbsp melted butter
- 3 tbsp granulated sugar
- 7 g dry yeast
- Salt
- Sesame seeds

Egg wash

- 1 egg
- 1 tbsp milk

Put the **yeast** in the **water** and let it wake up,¹ then add the **egg**, **butter**, **sugar**, and **salt**. Mix well while adding the **flour**. Let rise for 2h in a warm place.² Form the desired number of balls (4 to 8), set on an oven tray, cover, and let rise for another hour. Preheat the oven to 190°C, brush the buns with the well-mixed **egg** and **milk**, then bake for 15-20 minutes.

¹Add a pinch of flour and sugar to help. Wait a few minutes, until the surface foams.

²I usually leave it in the oven with the light on.

BURGER SAUCE

INGREDIENTS

- 125 g mayonnaise
- 60 g ketchup
- 15 g shallot or onion
- 25 g of sriracha or chili
- 15 g Dijon mustard
- 60 g (=1 medium) pickle
- ½ garlic clove
- 2 g salt (a generous pinch)
- 2 g pepper

Blend **all the ingredients** with a (hand-held) food processor and serve. Can be done without a food processor by finely mincing all the solid ingredients with a knife.

CAFÉ DE PARIS

INGRÉDIENTS

- 125 g de beurre
- 1 jaune d'œuf
- 1 càc généreuse de moutarde de Dijon
- ½ càs de Cognac (ou Brandy)
- ½ càc de vin blanc
- ½ càc de romarin
- ½ càc de persil
- 1 petite anchois
- ½ càc de thym
- ½ càc d'échalote haché
- ½ càc d'ail haché
- ½ càc de curry doux
- Pincée de sel
- Pincée de poivre
- Pincée de paprika

Mettre le **beurre** ramolli et tous les autres ingrédients dans un bol. Bien écraser et mélanger à la fourchette jusqu'à obtenir une pâte. À l'aide de film alimentaire, former un boudin et laisser raffermir au réfrigérateur.

MAC & CHEESE

Daniel's favorite. Serves 4 (o 1.5 Daniels)

INGREDIENTS

- 460 g elbow macaroni
- 60 g butter
- 36 g AP flour
- 480 ml milk
- Grated cheese:
 - 70 g blue cheese
 - 70g parmesan
 - 80 g shap cheddar
 - 60 g gouda
- 3 cloves of garlic, crushed or finely minced
- Salt and pepper

Start cooking the **macaroni** to *al dente*. In the meantime, melt the **butter** in a large stainless steel pan, add the **flour** and vigorously whisk until smooth.¹ While whisking, slowly add the **milk** to the mixture. Progressively add all the **grated cheese** and the **garlic**.

Season to taste with **salt and pepper**, then serve on the warm macaroni.

¹ The result is what the French call “*roux*”

PIADINE

Per 3 piadine

- 1 dl di acqua
- 180 g di farina
- 1 cucchiaio di latte
- 1 cucchiaio di olio d'oliva
- $\frac{1}{2}$ cucchiaino di sale

In una biella, mischiare insieme **tutti gli ingredienti**, aggiungendo la **farina** progressivamente.

Lasciare riposare l'impasto per 10 minuti (coperto o nella plastica in frigorifero).

Dividere in 3 palline e spianarle. Cuocere in padella a fuoco medio-alto per un minutino, finché si scuriscono e fanno delle bolle.

PIZZA NAPOLETANA

Dalla ricetta di Brian Lagerstrom. Per 4 pizze.

- 450 g di acqua
- 6 pizzichi di lievito in polvere ($\frac{1}{8}$ di cucchiaino)
- 665 g di farina 00
- 20 g di sale

Mettere il **lievito** nell'**acqua**,¹ poi aggiungere **farina** e **sale**. Mescolare bene con un cucchiaino, poi impastare con una planetaria² finché ben uniforme ed elastica. Coprire e lasciar riposare 30 minuti.

Eseguire qualche piega di rinforzo per sviluppare il glutine,³ poi coprire e lasciar riposare altri 30 minuti.

Eseguire un'altra piega di rinforzo, poi coprire e lasciar lievitare fuori dal frigo per 12h.

Separare il panetto in 4 palle, e metterle in frigo in contenitori oleati per almeno 2h, ma fino a 5 giorni.

Rimuovere dal frigo 3h prima di fare la pizza. Spianare bene le pizze su della farina, guarnire a piacere,^{4,5} poi cuocere in forno preriscaldato, idealmente su una pietra da forno, per circa 10 minuti (il sotto deve iniziare ad avere delle zone belle scure o lievemente sbruciacchiate).

*“A Napoli hanno inventato la pizza.
E tutti suonano il clacson,
perchè vogliono avere la pizza.”
—i fratelli Rizzello.*

¹Per attivare bene il lievito, metterlo nell'acqua calda con un cucchiaino di zucchero o farina per 5-10 minuti, finché schiuma.

²In assenza di una planetaria, si può impastare anche con le mani, ma come per il pane, il risultato sarà una crosta meno alveolata e soffice, e in generale meno professionale.

³*Pieghe di rinforzo*: senza togliere l'impasto dal suo contenitore, pizzica un lato del panetto e tiralo verso il lato opposto. Ripeti sui 4 lati del panetto, formando una 'X'. Gira il panetto sulla chiusura prima di lasciarlo riposare di nuovo. Brian Lagerstrom ha molti video, incluso quello nel link in questa ricetta, sotto al titolo, dove mostra come si esegue una piega di rinforzo.

⁴Suggerisco, dopo aver spianato la pizza (rigorosamente con le mani), di spostarla e guarnirla rapidamente su una pala di alluminio o legno ben infarinata. Il prelevamento della pizza già adornata direttamente dal tavolo richiede non poca destrezza e, in mani inesperte, spesso risulta nella distruzione della stessa. Inoltre, cerca di lasciare la pizza sulla pala il meno tempo possibile, soprattutto dopo aver aggiunto ingredienti bagnati (come il pomodoro), poiché l'umidità farà che la pizza appiccichi alla pala.

⁵In caso che il lettore, o uno degli aspiranti attavolati, preveda di guarnire la pizza con dell'*ananas*, voglio sottolineare che questo è un atto assolutamente barbarico, meritevole di pubblica umiliazione.

POLLO AL CESTELLO

La ricetta come ad Attinghausen. Per 2 persone.

INGREDIENTI

Per la marinatura

- 1 pollo da 1 kg
- 2dl di panna acidula
- 3 cucchiaini di olio d'oliva
- 1 cucchiaino di pepe
- 2 cucchiaini di sale
- un pizzico di aglio liofilizzato

- Vino bianco per sfumare
- 1 dl di brodo vegetale
- 2.5 dl di panna intera
- 1.5 cucchiaini di senape
- 0.5 cucchiaini di curry madras
- 0.5 cucchiaini di dragoncello
- 60 g di burro
- pepe q.b.
- sale q.b.

Per la salsa

- 1 scalogno grande o 2 piccoli
- 2 cucchiaini di olio d'oliva

Per accompagnare

- Patatine fritte
- Cornichons

Marinare il **pollo** nella mistura ben mescolata per minimo 4h in frigorifero, rigirando di tanto in tanto. Togliere dal frigo 30 min prima di infornarlo. Infornare il pollo nella parte centrale¹ a 200°C per circa 1h. Cuocere 20 minuti per lato, e poi in modalità grill altri 10 minuti per lato. Eventuali **patatine** vanno infornate negli ultimi 20 minuti, e per altri 10 minuti mentre il pollo riposa fuori dal forno.

Per la salsa, rolosare lo **scalogno** nell'**olio d'oliva** e sfumare col **vino** bianco. Evaporato il vino, aggiungere il **brodo** e cuocere 1 minuto. Aggiungere **panna**, **curry**, **pepe**, **dragoncello**, e **senape**. Sobbollire a fuoco dolce per 10-15 minuti (che si riduca un poco, il burro la allungherà comunque), quindi aggiungere il **burro** e infine regolare di **sale**. Nel caso, tenere la salsa al minimo mescolando di tanto in tanto fino a cottura del pollo. Che guardi bella lucida. Servire mezzo pollo per persona in un cestello con la salsa e mezzo cornichon, patatine da parte, e mangiare rigorosamente con le mani.

¹Volendo, direttamente sulla griglia. In questo caso, aggiungere una teglia con dell'acqua sotto al pollo, per raccogliere il grasso.

RISOTTO PATRIO

*Perfezionato, nella mia non modesta opinione, dalla versione di Carlo Emilio Gadda.
Per 4 commensali*

INGREDIENTI

- 1 cipolla tritata
- 350 g di riso per risotto (e.g., di tipo Vialone)
- Burro Lodigiano di classe, *quantum prodest*
- 1.5 L di brodo di carne saporito
- 0.2 g (o 50 stimmi) di zafferano
- Vino bianco per sfumare
- Parmigiano Reggiano grattugiato
- Funghi porcini, chanterelles, o spugnole

UTENSILI

- Casseruola di rame stagnato
- Ramaiolo
- Mestolo di legno

In una scodella marginale, preparare 1.5 L di **brodo** di carne **zafferanato**, da avere in pronto. Se disponibili, aggiungere al brodo anche i **funghi**. Nella casseruola, sciogliere del **burro**¹ e la **cipolla** in minimi pezzi. Al primo soffriggere del connubio butirroso-cipollino buttare il **riso**, da tostare e rosolare contro il fondo stagnato. Sfumare col **vino** bianco. Iniziare quindi la bollitura del riso, versando in piccole dosi il brodo fino a cottura avvenuta: che il riso non sia scotto, ma poco più che al dente. Tolto il risotto dal fuoco, **mantecarlo** e aggiungere tanto **parmigiano** quanto piace. Coprire con un coperchio e lasciar riposare per 10 minuti prima di servirlo con del pane rustico e un bicchiere di vino rosso.

¹ E, volendo, un cucchiaino colmo di olio d'oliva perchè il burro bruci meno facilmente.

SOUPE À L'OIGNON

Pour 4 portions

INGRÉDIENTS

Soupe

- 6 oignons jaunes
- 55 g de beurre
- 125 ml de vin rouge
- 30 ml de cognac
- ½ L de bouillon de poulet
- ½ L de bouillon de boeuf
- 1 c.à.s de farine
- 1 pincée de muscade

Garniture

- 200 g de Gruyère rapé
- Tranches de baguette grillées
- 1 gousse d'ail

Couper les **oignons** en quartiers, puis les émincer pour obtenir des courtes lanières. Dans une grande casserole, à feu moyen, attendrir les oignons dans le **beurre** pendant 15 minutes. Poursuivre à feu élevé 15 minutes, ou jusqu'à ce que les oignons soient caramélisés en remuant constamment et en grattant le fond. Déglacer avec le **vin** et le **cognac**, et réduire presque sec. Ajouter les **bouillons**, la **farine**, et la **muscade**. Mijoter à feu moyen-élevé 30 minutes, ou jusqu'à ce que la soupe ait réduit de moitié. Saler et poivrer.

Placer les bols de soupe dans le four avec le pain frotté avec l'ail, bien couvrir avec le fromage et griller.

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III SWEETS

BÜNDNER NUSSTORTE

ZUTATEN

Mürbeteig

- 325 g Mehl
- 100 g Zucker
- 1 TL Backpulver
- 1 Prise Salz
- 1 Ei
- 2 EL kaltes Wasser
- 175 g Butter

Füllung

- 200 g Zucker
- 0.5 dl heisses Wasser
- 2.5 dl Vollrahm
- 300 g Baumnüsse
- 50 g Honig

Mehl und **Butter** mit einem Mixer vermengen. Dann die Mehl-Butter-Mischung mit **Zucker**, **Backpulver** und **Salz** in einer Schüssel vermengen. Das **Ei** und das **Wasser** hinzufügen und mit einer Gabel mischen. In Folie verpackt etwa 30 Minuten kühlstellen.

Für die Füllung, **Zucker** langsam caramelisieren, **Wasser** dazu giessen, aufkochen. **Rahm** begeben, köcheln bis sich das Caramel aufgelöst hat. **Nüsse** und **Honig** daruntermischen. Einige Minuten rühren, bis eine dickliche Masse entsteht. Dann abkühlen lassen.

Backofen auf 200°C Unter-Oberhitze vorheizen. Teig dritteln. Ein Drittel Teig zu einer Rondelle von etwa 24 cm ø auswallen, kühl stellen. Restlichen Teig auf wenig Mehl zu einer Rondelle von etwa 32 cm ø auswahlen und in die gebutterte form legen. Die Füllung darauf verteilen. Teigränder nach innen legen, und Torte mit der Rondelle zudecken. Rand mit einer Gabel gut andrücken, und Deckel einstechen. Torte auf der mittleren Schiene etwa 30 Minuten backen. Vollständig auskühlen lassen (das ist ziemlich wichtig).

THE PERFECT CHEESECAKE

A recipe by Jerry P. Fairley, reproduced almost verbatim from his own cookbook.

INGREDIENTS

Crust

- 2 cups (200 g) graham cracker crumbs
- 2 tbsp (25 g) granulated sugar
- Pinch of salt
- 5 tbsp (70 g) unsalted butter

Filling

- 2 lbs (900 g) cream cheese **at room T°**
- 1½ cups (265 g) granulated sugar
- Pinch of salt
- 2 tsp vanilla extract
- 4 large eggs¹
- ⅔ cup (160 g) sour cream
- ⅔ cup (160 g) heavy whipping cream

Toppings (optional)

- 2 cups (460 g) sour cream
- ⅓ cup (40 g) powdered sugar
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 12 oz (340 g) fresh raspberries, blackberries, or strawberries, finely diced
- ½ cup (100 g) granulated sugar
- ½ cup (120 g) water

Special equipment

- a 9-in (23 cm) diameter, 2¾ inch (7 cm) high springform pan
- Heavy-duty **18-in (45 cm) wide** aluminum foil (do not try to use regular-width aluminum foil)
- Parchment paper
- A large, high-sided roasting pan (large enough to contain the springform pan)

Crust:

Unroll a sheet of **parchment paper** the size of the **springform pan**. Using the bottom of the springform pan as a pattern, draw a circle on the parchment paper and carefully cut it out. It should just fit in the bottom of the pan. Set the parchment circle aside for now.

Spread out a kitchen towel on the counter and set the springform pan, upside-down, on the towel.² Carefully and gently tear-off a square of the wide **aluminum foil** that will completely cover the entire bottom and sides of the springform pan. Place the foil over the bottom of the pan and gently fold the

¹ US standard, ~57 g each

² To avoid tearing or puncturing the delicate aluminum foil

foil down over the sides, then turn the pan over and crimp the foil all around the lip. Do all of this very carefully, on top of the towel, so you don't get even a little pinhole in the foil—if you do, start over with a new piece of aluminum foil. Once you get the first layer of aluminum foil on the springform pan, turn the pan upside-down again and put another piece of aluminum foil over the bottom and sides of the pan in exactly the same way as the first piece. This second layer of foil is an insurance policy in case the first layer has a tiny pinhole that you missed.

Put the **butter** in a microwave-proof bowl and heat it for 30 seconds. Wait for a couple of minutes, then swirl the bowl around and heat it again for 30 s. Let the bowl sit until any solid butter that is left melts completely. Place a baking rack in the bottom third of the oven and preheat to 350°F (177°C). Roughly break-up the **graham crackers** and pulse them in a food processor until they are finely-ground. Put the crumbs in a small or medium mixing bowl. Stir in the **sugar** and pinch of **salt**, then pour in the melted butter and mix well with your hands.

Keeping the pan on the kitchen towel (to minimize the chance of pinholes in the foil), put the circle of parchment paper into the bottom, inside the foil-wrapped springform pan, and dump in all the graham cracker crust mixture. Press the crumbs into the bottom of the pan,³ leaving just a slightly thicker crust along the outside edge of the pan. Be very careful not to tear the aluminum foil while you do this (or while doing anything else).⁴ Carefully (so you don't make a hole in the aluminum foil) place the springform pan on the rack in the oven and bake for 10 minutes. Remove the pan and place it on the kitchen towel. Reduce the oven temperature to 325°F (325°C).

Filling:

You can do all the following steps with a handheld electric mixer; however, if you have one, it is (a lot) easier to use a stand-mixer, and the finished product is actually better. Although it's hard work to mix the ingredients enough with a hand-mixer, with persisence, you can do it. The moral of the story is: if you want a good cheesecake, don't short the mixing times below, just because you are using a hand-mixer!

Put 2 quarts of water on to boil while you are preparing the filling, and keep them hot. You will need them after you make the filling, when you bake the cheesecake.

Cut the **cream cheese** up into chunks and place it all in a large mixing

³I usually use the bottom of a measuring cup first, then my fingers (or a spoon) to finish the job.

⁴If it seems as though I'm making a really big deal out of getting a hole in the aluminium foil, that's because I am. Even the tiniest hole will let water in the pan and spoil the crust. Making a good filling is tedious, but easy. The hardest part of making a good cheesecake is keeping the crust from being soggy. Trust me on this—it took me years to work out the crust part.

bowl. Mix the cream cheese⁵ on medium speed for at least 4 minutes, or until it is light and fluffy. Add the **sugar**, then beat the mixture for another 4 minutes. Add the **salt** and beat for 2 minutes, then add the **vanilla** and beat for another 2 minutes. Add the **eggs**, one at a time, beating the batter for 1 minute after adding each egg. Add the **sour cream**, beating for 4 minutes, then add the **heavy cream**, beating for another 4 minutes. After each addition (sugar, salt, vanilla, eggs, sour cream, heavy cream), use a spatula to scrape the bottom and sides of the mixing bowl, to make sure all the little chunks of cream cheese get whipped and all the ingredients are completely incorporated.

Baking the cheesecake:

Carefully set the foil-wrapped springform pan in the large, high-sided roasting pan. Pour the cream cheese filling into the springform pan, on top of the graham cracker crust, and gently smooth the top with a rubber spatula if needed. Place the roasting pan (with the springform pan inside) on the lower rack (i.e., in the bottom third) of the oven. Pour the hot water (heated up in the previous step) into the roasting pan until it comes about halfway up the sides of the springform pan. The water should be 1¼ to 1½ inches (3 to 4 cm) deep.

Bake the cheesecake in the oven at 325°F (165°C) for at least 1½ hours. After 1½ hours, check to see if the cake is done by putting a bamboo skewer or a knife into the middle of the cake; if it comes out clean, the cake is done, but if there is goop (filling) on the knife, it needs more time. The top should be lightly browned; if it starts to look too brown, but the cheesecake still isn't completely done, use a piece of aluminum foil to loosely cover the top. The exact baking time is probably highly dependent on the oven. The original recipe says 1½ hours, but I have found it takes closer to 2½ hours in our oven, and I sometimes resort to turning up the temperature to 350°F (175°C). Make sure to top-up the water in the roasting pan if it gets too low, but I rarely find I need to add more water.

Once the cheesecake is set, turn off the oven and open the door about an inch, leaving the cheesecake inside. Let the cake cool for at least another hour, or longer if you like. I usually leave it until it is almost completely at room temperature. This helps keep the top of the cheesecake from developing cracks.

Once the cheesecake is cooled, take it out of the oven and cover it with foil, without letting the foil touch the top of the cheesecake. Put it in the refrigerator and chill overnight, or for a minimum of 4 hours.

Preparing the toppings:

While the cheesecake is baking, place the **sour cream** in a medium sized bowl and stir in the powdered sugar and vanilla. Mix until smooth, then cover and chill until you are ready to serve the cake.

⁵ If you have a stand-mixer, use the paddle attachment.

Put the **raspberries** (or **blackberries**, or **strawberries**, or whatever you are using), **sugar**, and **water** into a small saucepan. Simmer the mixture, occasionally using a potato masher to crush-up the fruit. After about 5–10 minutes the syrup will begin to get a little thicker. Once it starts to thicken, remove it from the heat and let it cool. Be careful not to overdo it, because the sauce will thicken more as it cools.

Serving the Cheesecake:

Take the cheesecake out of the refrigerator and remove the aluminum foil. Getting the springform pan off the cake without messing it up can be a little tricky. Try running a blunt knife around the inside of the pan, between the pan and the cake, before opening the latch on the pan. You can also try warming the sides of the pan (the original recipe suggests using a hair-dryer, but I've never had much success with that—I just use a knife). It might help to let the pan sit outside the refrigerator for 10–15 minutes before trying to unmold it, so the sides of the pan can warm up a little.

Anyway, once you unmold the springform pan from the cake, spread the top of the cheesecake with about half the sour cream topping. I suggest using a hot knife to cut the cake. I keep a kitchen towel (or paper towels) and a tall drinking glass full of hot water next to the cake; in between cutting each slice, I stick the knife in the water for a minute, then dry it off with the towel. This makes a mess of the towel, but you can always wash that later. Drizzle a little of the raspberry syrup on each slice and serve.

Note that the recipe for the sour cream topping makes more than you really need. I serve it on the side for people who want extra, but you can also serve the cheesecake without any sour cream dressing (or raspberry sauce, for that matter). The toppings are optional, and you can decide if you want to make (and use) them or not, depending on your tastes.

Making a cheesecake is a lot of work, although it does get easier after you've done it a few times. As I mentioned above, using a stand-mixer is a big help. Most of all, however, I have found the best cheesecakes are made with love! Love of baking, certainly, and also love for the person for whom you are making it. I don't know if you've ever noticed this, but I never make a cheesecake for myself—it's always easier to make it for someone that is dear to you.

TARTE AU VIN CUIT

ou “Tarte au Raisinée”.

INGRÉDIENTS

- 250 g de pâte sucrée (voir la recette à la page 14)
- 3 œufs
- 1 jaune d’œuf
- 1.4 dl de crème double
- 1 dl de vin cuit vaudoise

Préparer la **pâte sucrée** et laisser-la reposer. Abaisser la pâte à $\frac{1}{2}$ cm d’épaisseur et foncer une plaque de 20 cm de $\varnothing$, beurrée et farinée. Faire cuire la pâte à blanc,¹ 25 minutes environ, dans le four à 250°C. Laisser refroidir sans démouler.

Préparer l’appareil à flan en mélangeant au fouet le **reste des ingrédients**.² Remplir le fond de pâte, transporter-la dans le four préchauffé à 180°C et achever de remplir à ras bords, une fois le gâteau dans le four, en s’aidant d’une cuillère.

Laisser la porte du four entrouverte jusqu’à ce que le flan soit pris, une demi-heure environ, et vérifier son degré de cuisson en secouant légèrement le moule. Démouler à tiède sur une grille.

¹ Pour éviter que le fond de la pâte ne gonfle pendant la cuisson à blanc, le masquer par un disque de papier aluminium ou cuisson, et couvrir avec des pois chiches pour bien le tenir en place.

² Selon le degré de réduction du vin cuit, il faudra peut-être en augmenter la quantité jusqu’à 1.2 dl.